

posts for himself on the queenside – b4 is obvious, but after he plays .. e7-e5 the c5-square will also fall into his hands. A possible continuation is 8 Be2 0-0 9 h4 e5 10 d5 Na6 11 Bg5 Nc5 12 Qc2 Qb6 13 Ra3 (to prevent .. Nb3-d4) 13.. Bd7 with a comfortable game.

7...b5 8 cxb5

The immediate e4-e5 is not very dangerous as after an exchange on e5 White will have to take back awkwardly on d1. However, 8 0-0 0-0 9 e5! is quite good for White so Black should probably play 8 ..Nbd7.

8...axb5 9 b4 0-0 10 Rb1

I'm not too convinced by White's plan. He is playing half-heartedly on both wings.

10...Nbd7 11 0-0 Bb7 12 Bg5 b6 13 Be3 e5 14 Qc2 Qe7 15 Rfd1 exd4 16 Bxd4 h5 17 f3 Ne5 (Diagram 9)

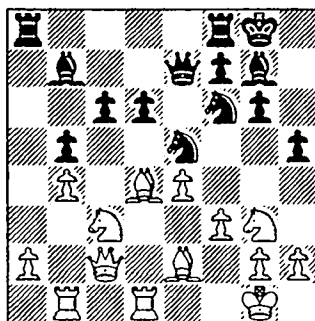


Diagram 9

Black has the better prospects.

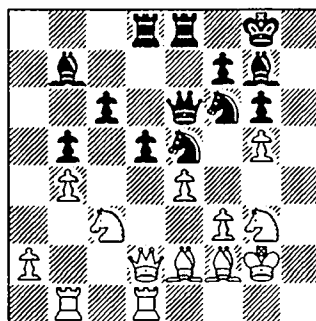


Diagram 10

How does Black continue?

White is kept occupied by the hole on c4 as the last thing he would want is a black knight establishing itself there. The move f2-f3, which was required to protect e4, has also slightly weakened the kingside.

18 Nf1 h4 19 Qd2!? Rfe8 20 Bf2 Nh5! 21 g4

21 Qxd6 Qg5 with ...Nf4 to follow is much too dangerous for White. I wasn't too unhappy to see the text either as the white king position is beginning to open up.

21...hxc3 22 hxc3 Rad8 23 g4 Nf6 24 Ng3 Qe6 25 Kg2?

White should have played 25 g5. Now he is losing

25...d5! 26 g5 (Diagram 10) 26...Nxf3!

White had seen that 26...dxe4 27 Qxd8 wasn't so clear but completely overlooked this shot. Of course 27 Bxf3 just loses to 27.. dxe4.

27 Qf4 Nxe4!

If White takes on f3 Black takes on c3 and if White takes on e4 Black recaptures defending his knight on f3.

28 Ncxe4 dxe4 29 Nxe4 Nd4 30 Bxd4 Rxd4 31 Bf3 Qxa2+ 32 Kg1 c5 33 Nf6+ Bxf6 34 Qxf6 Rg4+! 35 Kf1

35 Bxg4 Qg2 mate and 35 Kh1 Qf2! were alternative wins.

35...Qc4+ 36 Kf2 Re2+! White resigns

White resigned because of 37 Bxe2 Rg2+ 38 Ke3 Rxe2.

The Smyslov Variation

We shall now look at the Smyslov system where White plays an early Bg5. Play starts 1 d4 Nf6 2 c4 g6 3 Nc3 Bg7 4 Nf3 d6 (0-0) 5 Bg5 and now White will follow up with e2-e3 (Diagram 11).

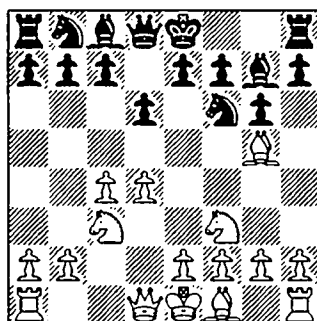


Diagram 11

Quiet, but dangerous

This can be quite a dangerous line for Black. In my early days as a King's Indian player I struggled a bit playing with ...e7-e5. The turning point for me came when I suddenly noticed a game where Smyslov was playing Black against his own system. He played with ...c7-c5 and won really easily. I copied him and my results improved dramatically. I therefore suggest that Black plays the Smyslov Defence to the Smyslov Variation. This is examined in Game 68.

Theoretical?

The knowledge required for Black is not too extensive but he should definitely be prepared for the Smyslov System. It can be unpleasant if he isn't prepared and it also has quite a large band of supporters

Statistics

In the Smyslov system White has scored 56%. When Black plays with an early ...c7-c5 White scores even higher at 59% but this is because the vast majority of Black players don't follow up correctly.

Illustrative Games

Game 67

□ Sharif ■ Mamedov

Abu Dhabi 2001

1 d4 Nf6 2 c4 g6 3 Nc3 Bg7 4 Nf3 0-0 5 Bg5 0-0 6 e3 Nbd7

Black prepares ...e7-e5. 6...c5! is the subject of the next game

7 Qc2!

White wants to be able to meet ...e7-e5 with Rd1.

7...c6 8 Be2 a6

After 8...e5 9 Rd1 Qc7 10 0-0 h6 11 Bh4 another one of the points of Qc2 is revealed.

Exercise 11: Black would like to remove White's bishop with 11...g5 12 Bg3 Nh5 (Diagram 14) but this is not a good idea. Why?

9 0-0 h6 10 Bh4 e5 (Diagram 12)

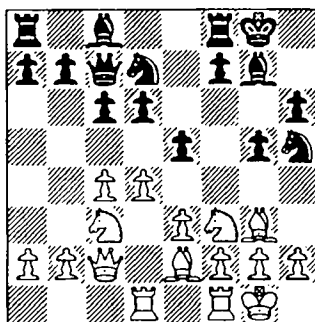


Diagram 12

Does Black get the bishop pair?

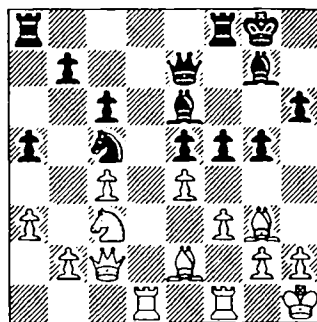


Diagram 13

A well-timed thrust

After preparing ...b7-b5 it seems strange not to play it. Nevertheless, the position after 10 ...b5 11 a3 Bb7 12 Nd2 is quite unpleasant for Black as I can testify from personal experience.

11 dxe5

There was no reason to release the central tension. 11 Rfd1 looks like a good move.

11...dxe5 12 Rad1 Qe7 13 a3 a5 14 Nd2 Nc5 15 Nb3 Nxb3 16 Qxb3 g5 17 Bg3 Nd7 18 f3 Nc5 19 Qc2 f5 20 Kh1 Be6 21 e4 (Diagram 13) 21...fxe4

Note how White only played e4 when the knight on c5 could no longer go to c6. It was possible for Black to play 21...f4 but after 22 Bf2 Rad8 White can play 23 Nd5! cxd5 24 cxd5 when he regains the piece with

a sizeable advantage.

22 Nxe4 Bf5 23 Bd3! Nxd3 24 Qxd3 Rad8 25 Qe2 Rfe8 26 Bf2 Bxe4 27 fxe4 Qc7 28 h3 Rxd1 29 Rxd1 Rd8 30 Kg1 Rxd1+ 31 Qxd1 Bf8 32 Qa4 b6 33 b4 axb4 34 axb4 c5? 35 b5 h5?! 36 Qd1 h4 37 Qd5+ Kg7 38 Be3 Black resigns

Game 68

□ Pachman ■ Smyslov

Amsterdam 1994

1 d4 Nf6 2 c4 g6 3 Nc3 Bg7 4 Nf3 0-0 5 Bg5 d6 6 e3 c5 7 Be2

After 7 dxc5 dxc5 8 Qxd8 Rxd8 White would have to play well to draw the endgame. Sometimes White blocks the centre with 7 d5 when 7...h6 8 Bh4 e5 would be standard play, but Black could also try 8...Qb6, hoping to reach similar positions to the main line.

7...h6 8 Bh4 Bf5!? (Diagram 14)

There are a couple of good reasons for putting the bishop on f5. Firstly it enables Black to play ...Ne4. After the knights on f6 and c3 have disappeared the bishop on g7 becomes very powerful. The second reason is that it covers b1 and in a surprising number of variations this allows Black to mount a decisive assault against the b2-pawn.

9 0-0 Nbd7!?

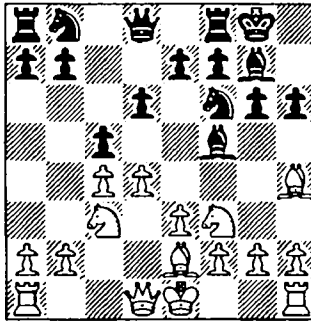


Diagram 14

Exploiting White's reticent e2-e3

Preparing ...Qb6, which is not playable at once in view of 10 Bxf6 followed by Nd5. The immediate 9...Ne4 is an interesting alternative.

10 d5?!

A strange decision. 10 Rcl is more logical so that White can meet 10...Qb6 with 11 b3. Still, in Law-Gallagher, British Championship 1997 Black had an attractive position after 11...Rfe8 12 h3?! g5! 13 Bg3 Ne4 14 Nxe4 Bxe4 15 dxc5 Nxc5 16 Nd4 Rad8.

10...Qb6! 11 Na4

Not a good square for the knight but both 11 Qd2 g5 12 Bg3 Ne4 13

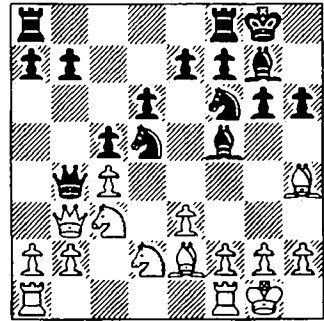


Diagram 15

White's bishop on h4 is loose

Nxe4 Bxe4 and 11 Qb3 g5 12 Bg3 Ne4 13 Nxe4 Bxe4 14 Nd2 Bg6 seem to lose a pawn.

11...Qa5 12 Nd2 Nb6 13 Nc3

13 Nxb6 Qxb6 again leaves the b-pawn in difficulties. Now White hopes that his problems can be solved by advancing e4, but Smyslov was ready for that one

13...Qb4! 14 Qb3 Nbx d5! (Diagram 15)

And now we know why Smyslov didn't succumb to any urge he may have felt to play ...g6-g5. The exposed position of the bishop on h4 is the key point in this simple, but pleasing combination

15 cxd5

Or 15 Nxd5 Nxd5 16 Qxb4 Nxb4 17 Bxe7 Rfe8 18 Bxd6 Rad8 is winning for Black

15...Qxh4 16 Qxb7 Qb4!

Black's last few moves illustrate well the power of the queen.

17 Qxb4

There is no choice for White as 17 Qxc7 Qxb2 loses material.

17...cxb4 18 Nb5 Nxd5! 19 Bf3 Bd3! 20 Bxd5 Bxb5 21 Bxa8 Bxf1 22 Be4 Ba6 White resigns

Summary

- 1) The systems in this chapter are not inferior systems for White, as can be seen from the statistics, they are just played a bit less often than the others.
- 2) 5 Bd3 is a solid system where White tries to reduce the impact of Black playing ...f7-f5. It appeals to players who don't want to work too much as White usually plays the same initial moves against whatever Black does.
- 3) White's main idea with 5 Nge2 is to play Ng3 and then advance his h-pawn. It is quite playable for Black to castle into this attack but he must take care about sacrifices on h5. Certain Black players prefer to delay castling to frustrate White's attacking ambitions.
- 4) The Smyslov system is an awkward line for Black if he insists on playing for ...e7-c5, but a relatively easy ride if he plays ...c7-c5.